

SULOCHANA DEVI

A STORY OF HUMANITY, NEGLECT AND DISAPPEARANCE

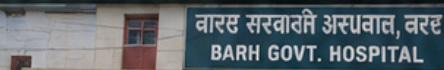
1 ONE NIGHT IN NOVEMBER 2025

In Barh, one night in November 2025, very well known Volunteer **Aryan** told me that an old woman is very sick who need medical attention.

He discussed this matter to a well known social service provider to admit her in Barh Govt Hospital.



2 A KIND HEART STEPS FORWARD



The well known kind hearted Social worker came in the morning and discussed with the doctor to allot a bed to her. And it happened. One bed was allotted to her.

But we did not see happiness in her face.

3 I TOOK RESPONSIBILITY

I just involved in this case in the middle of caring Mr. Sudarshan Tiwari, the abandoned sick heavy infected wound old man.

I added her in my daily scheduled as an attendant of both.



"Some people wait for the right time to help. I just act when a soul needs me."

4 THE NEXT DAY... A PAINFUL TRUTH

The next day, I saw her sitting near the ticket counter of Barh Govt Hospital.

When I asked, she replied with tears in her eyes...



"You people have humanity at least. But the medical staff ignored me when I ask for help."

5 HER HEART-WRENCHING WORDS

I suffered a lot to go for bathroom.

I was unable to come down from bed, so I asked for help but nobody helped me.

On the other hand, they kept two dead bodies near me all night.

When I tried myself to come down and go for toilet, I fell down and it hurt me too.

So I think it is better to stay outside remaining disappeared from you people's eye.

You wanted to avail facility on the faith of hospital norm. But I did not see humanity ever.

6 I LISTENED... AND UNDERSTOOD

Then I suddenly changed the topic to avoid crying in front of her. I gently asked,

Yes mother, I believe what you tell."

"Ok, I want to know about your situation can you tell."

Then she said...



7 ABOUT HER LIFE

- She was a teacher in her working period.
- She never sought for dependency at all.
- Her parents were dead.
- A sister was her in blood relation. But she did not bother her.
- She was living near Bhubaneswari Chawk alone.
- Her neighbour somewhat helped her.



8 A DAY IN HER LIFE AT HOSPITAL

She is inside the premises of hospital because of illness.

It was rainy day, she was not walk properly.

I arranged blanket, mat and pillow for her.

But in all my caregiving operation, I thought often...

"If I have more space then I must take care of these people with love of my heart, treating them as my blood relation. In general I live a life of 'Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam'. I equally respect both animals, birds and humanbeings too. Here lack of resources pull me to hell."



9 HOW I CARED FOR HER

I used to offer food, water and medicines by discussing with doctor.

Before 9 am and after 7 pm, then attend Sudarshan Tiwari.

"Rooti Bank" have been doing a great job about offering food and water.

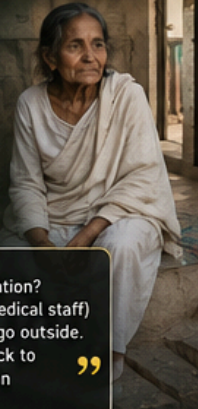
They cover till railway station.



10 SHE GOT BETTER... BUT THEN

- Gradually, the old lady quite recovered from loose motion and fever.
- Now she started changing position like Sudarshan but in close proximity area.

"One day I saw and asked her why did you change your location? She said, 'They (guard and medical staff) regularly say why don't you go outside. So I made my mind to go back to my cottage. Kindly arrange an auto for me tomorrow.'"



11 THE DISAPPEARANCE

I keep posting daily care taken by me in WhatsApp to Aryan.

Tomorrow we came to that location but found her nowhere.

Then searched at her cottage by asking neighbour but nobody knows.

She disappeared like Sudarshan Tiwari.

Some people just come into our life to teach us humanity and then silently vanish."



12 NO RESPONSE... ONLY SILENCE

I tried same way like Sudarshan case mailing high authorised personnel...

But no response I got.



HER NAME WAS SULOCHANA DEVI

A RESPECTFUL TEACHER. A FORGOTTEN SOUL. A VICTIM OF SYSTEM, NOT OF FATE.



"When we have nothing, we still have our humanity. When the world turns its face, let us be the hand that helps."

I WILL CONTINUE... BECAUSE THEY ARE ALSO A PART OF MY FAMILY.



Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam
The World Is One Family

SULOCHANA DEVI

A Story of a Single, Unmarried Woman — Illness, Dignity, Humanity and a Sudden Disappearance

Some people disappear from our daily lives, but their stories remain behind — quietly asking us what humanity really means.



Sulochana Devi during the period when she was living within the premises of Barh Government Hospital.

This story is based on the personal observations and caregiving experiences of Satyabrata Das during November 2025 and the days that followed.

1. One Message on a November Night

One night in November 2025, in Barh, I received information from Aryan, a volunteer known in the local area for his involvement in social work. He told me about an elderly woman who was seriously unwell and needed medical attention. The matter was discussed with a kind-hearted social worker who tried to arrange her admission to Barh Government Hospital.

The next morning, the social worker came to the hospital and spoke with the doctors. After discussion, a bed was allotted to her. On paper, it looked like good news: an elderly sick woman had finally received a hospital bed. Yet when I saw her, I did not see happiness on her face.

At that time, I was already deeply involved in another difficult caregiving case — that of Mr. Sudarshan Tiwari, an abandoned elderly man suffering from serious health problems and an infected wound. Still, after learning about this woman, I added her to my already demanding daily caregiving routine. From that point onward, I tried to attend to both lives as much as my limited time and resources allowed.

2. “At Least You People Have Humanity”

The following day, I saw her sitting near the ticket counter of Barh Government Hospital. I was surprised and asked why she was sitting there instead of resting on the bed that had been arranged for her.

Her reply left a deep impression on me. She said, in essence, that people like us had at least shown her some humanity. She told me that she had felt ignored when she needed help. Because of her weakness, even going to the bathroom had become difficult. She said she had asked for assistance but felt that nobody came to help her. She also described a frightening and lonely night in which deceased patients were kept nearby. When she later tried to get down from the bed and go to the toilet by herself, she fell and was hurt.

She told me that she no longer wanted to remain where she felt unseen. In her words, she had expected the facilities of a hospital to come with a sense of human care, but she felt she had not experienced that humanity.

I could see the pain in her face. I did not want to make her feel more helpless or cause her to break down in front of me. So I gently changed the subject.

“Yes, Mother,” I told her. “I believe what you are saying. Now, if you are comfortable, please tell me about yourself.”

3. The Life Behind the Illness

Her name was Sulochana Devi.

As she slowly spoke about her life, I came to know that she had once been a teacher. During her working years, she had lived with self-respect and independence. She had never wanted to depend on others. Her parents had passed away. She had a sister, her closest blood relation, but she did not wish to trouble her.

She had been living alone near Bhuvaneshwari Chowk. Some neighbours offered her limited help when they could. But illness can change everything. A person who has spent a lifetime standing independently can suddenly find even the smallest daily task difficult.

I listened to her story and thought about how quickly a person can become invisible when age, illness and loneliness come together. A former teacher. An unmarried woman. Living alone. No close family member beside her. No permanent attendant. No certainty about who would be there the next morning.

4. A Rainy Day and a Small Arrangement

During that period, the weather was rainy and she was not able to walk properly. I arranged a blanket, a mat and a pillow for her so that she could rest with at least a little comfort. These were small things, but sometimes small things are all a person has between discomfort and dignity.

In the middle of my caregiving work, I often thought: if only I had more space and more resources, I would take better care of such abandoned and helpless people with all my heart, treating them like my own blood relatives.

My personal belief has long been close to the spirit of *Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam* — the idea that the whole world is one family. For me, this feeling does not stop with human beings. I try to respect animals, birds and human beings with the same basic sense of compassion. But compassion without resources can become a painful struggle. Many times, lack of money, space, transport and support feels like a wall standing between the wish to help and the ability to do more.

5. Two Lives in One Daily Routine

My days became tightly scheduled. Before 9:00 a.m. and again after 7:00 p.m., I tried to provide Sulochana Devi with food, water and medicines after discussing her medical needs with the doctor. In between, I also had to continue attending to Mr. Sudarshan Tiwari.

At the same time, the people of Roti Bank were doing valuable work by providing food and water to people in need, including those around the railway station. Their service represented an important form of practical compassion in the area.

Day by day, Sulochana Devi gradually recovered from loose motion and fever. Her strength began to return. She started changing her sitting and resting position and moved within nearby areas. Yet this improvement created another difficulty for me: sometimes I had to search for her because she would change locations.

6. Why Did You Change Your Location?

One day I found her and asked gently why she had moved from the place where I expected to find her.

She told me that guards and some hospital staff regularly asked her why she did not go outside. Whether these words were spoken casually or out of frustration, they had clearly affected her. She had made up her mind to return to her small cottage.

She then made a simple request: please arrange an auto for me tomorrow.

I continued posting updates about the care being provided to her in WhatsApp messages to Aryan. The next day, we went to the location where we expected to find her.

She was not there.

7. Another Disappearance

We searched for Sulochana Devi at the hospital premises. Then we went toward her cottage and asked neighbours. Nobody could tell us clearly where she had gone.

She had disappeared from our view — much like Mr. Sudarshan Tiwari had disappeared from mine earlier.

I tried the same approach I had used in the Sudarshan Tiwari case. I sent messages and emails to higher authorities, hoping that someone might respond or help trace what had happened. But this time too, I received no meaningful response.

And so, the story remains unfinished.

Did she safely return to her cottage? Did she receive help from someone else? Did she travel somewhere? Was she able to manage alone? I do not know. What I know is that for a period of time, our paths crossed — and during that time, I saw the quiet struggle of an elderly woman who had once been independent, educated and self-reliant, but who later found herself alone and ill.

8. The Question Her Story Leaves Behind

Sulochana Devi's story is not only about one elderly woman. It raises larger questions about ageing, loneliness, public care and the meaning of humanity. A bed can be allotted. A medicine can be prescribed. A record can be created. But when a weak person needs help to stand, walk, eat, drink or reach a bathroom, humanity cannot exist only on paper.

A person may spend an entire lifetime without asking anyone for support. But old age and illness can force even the strongest individual to depend on others. At that moment, dignity becomes as important as treatment.

I did not know Sulochana Devi for a lifetime. I met her during a difficult chapter of her life. I could not solve every problem. I did not have the resources to give her a permanent home or a full-time attendant. But I could offer what was within my power: food, water, basic comfort, attention,

conversation and the feeling that at least someone was willing to see her.

9. In Memory of a Woman Who Refused to Become Invisible

Sulochana Devi was a teacher. She was single and unmarried. She lived independently for much of her life. She did not want to burden her sister. In illness, she found herself alone. Yet even in that helpless situation, she still spoke with clarity about dignity and humanity.

I do not know where she is today.

But I hope she is safe.

And I hope that wherever she went, someone offered her the kindness she was asking for.

Written from personal experience and observation by Satyabrata Das

A caregiver and rescuer who believes that compassion should not depend on whether a life is human, animal or bird.

This narrative has been edited for clarity and readability while preserving the central events and meaning shared by the caregiver.